A-A-51645
5 September 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BUTTRESS, SUTURE (POLYTETRAFLUOROETHYLENE)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers a suture buttress suitable for use in cardiovascular surgery.

Salient characteristics:

Style and design. The buttress shall be a 150 ± 5 mm wide by 150 ± 5 mm, 1.8 ± .2 mm thick, felt pad suture buttress. Shall be fabricated from the material specified below.

Material. The buttress shall be fabricated from polytetrafluoroethylene (PTFE) felt.

Toxicity. The buttress shall be non-toxic when tested in accordance with the Systemic Injection Test and Intracutaneous Test specified in the latest edition of USP under Biological Tests - Plastics. This testing shall be done at the Class II level.

As an alternate, toxicity testing of suture buttresses may be done in accordance with ASTM F895.

Pyrogenicity. The buttress shall be non-pyrogenic when tested as specified in monograph #151 of the latest edition of the USP.

Thermal stability. The buttress shall pass the thermal stability test specified below.

Thermal stability test. Subject sample buttresses to cyclic steam autoclaving in a high speed sterilizer at 270° and 30 psig for 10 ± 1/2 minutes. Use a total of 10 cycles. After each cycle, examine the samples for swelling, tackiness, hardening, or staining.

As an alternate, sample buttresses may be steam autoclaved in a standard gravity sterilizer at 250°F and 15 psig for 30 ± 1/2 minutes. Complete this version of the test by following the examination and cycling procedures listed above.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

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Workmanship. The buttress shall be free from abrasion marks, broken filaments, lint, clip marks, color staining and streaks, fuzziness, gout, surface dirt, slugs, weak spots, and any other defects that detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability. Definitions of defects listed above shall be in accordance with Appendix A4 of ASTM D123, "Standard Definitions of Terms Relating to Textiles."

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing six buttresses, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 at level S-1, AQL 0.65%. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one buttress.

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